Dylan Cease

TOR · RHP · Starter · Age 30 · 2,896 pitches · 29 G

Pitcher evaluation
2026 regular season
Data through **2026-09-27**
MLBAM 656302

IP	ERA	FIP	XFIP	XERA	K%	BB%	K-BB%	CSW%	WHIFF%	CHASE%	FB VELO
169.0	2.40	2.56	2.92	2.92	34.9%	11.4%	23.5%	29.8%	30.4%	31.7%	96.8

BOTTOM LINE

1. **Best pitch: slider (65 Stuff / 65 Results):** 41.6% whiff, .218 xwOBA, 30% usage; already his 2-strike weapon (37% of 2K pitches).
2. **Primary FB velo down 2.4 mph** over his last 5 games (94.9 vs 97.3 baseline); IL from Sep 20 (right shoulder inflammation) — verify health/mechanics before projecting.
3. **Elite run prevention by xERA:** 2.40 ERA, 2.92 xERA (91st pct), 2.56 FIP, 23.5% K-BB.
4. **Underused changeup (70 Results):** .195 xwOBA, 45% whiff, RV/100 +1.0 on only 11% usage (19% vs LHH / 1% vs RHH).
5. **Plus-plus bat-missing (70):** 34.9% K, 30.4% whiff/swing (94th pct), 29.8% CSW.

20–80 GRADES

vs 424 pitchers ≥600 pitches

Stuff	65	+0.47 RV/100
Command	40	BB 11.4%
Bat-missing	70	Whiff 30%
Contact mgmt	55	xwOBAcon .341
Durability	75	IP/GS 5.8

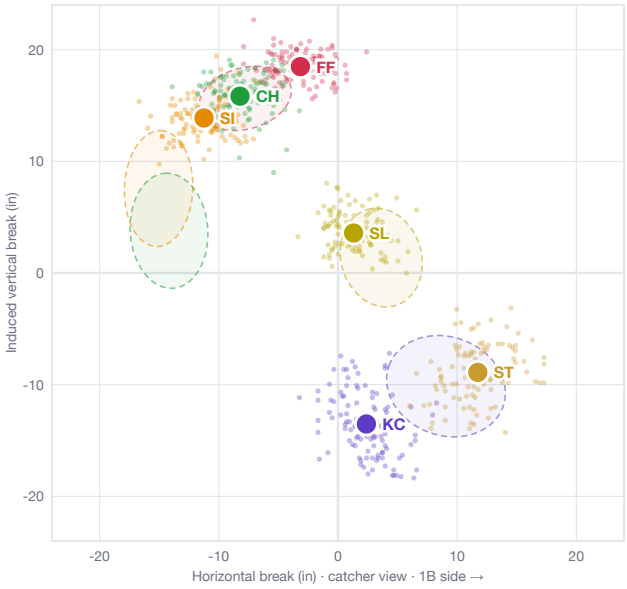
ARSENAL Arsenal — slider is the best pitch by shape (65 Stuff, plus)

Velo mph · spin rpm · IVB/HB inches, catcher view (HB + = toward 1B) · Ext ft · Whiff per swing · Chase = swing % outside zone · xwOBA per PA ended · RV/100 = count-neutral run value per 100 pitches, + = good for pitcher · cells tinted by percentile within pitch type & hand · grey rows: n < 100

		USAGE			USAGE BY COUNT				SHAPE					RESULTS					GRADES (20–80)		
PITCH	N	ALL	VL	VR	0-0	AHD	BHD	2K	VELO	SPIN	IVB	HB	EXT	WHIFF	CHASE	CSW	XWOBA	RV/100	STUFF	RES	CMD
Four-seam FF	1071	**37%**	38%	35%	36%	34%	40%	38%	96.8	2457	18.5	-3.2	6.4	21%	32%	26%	.307	+0.9	65	55	45
Slider SL	871	**30%**	25%	38%	21%	32%	34%	37%	88.7	2706	3.6	1.3	6.4	42%	43%	35%	.218	+2.8	65	65	50
Changeup CH	332	**11%**	19%	1%	9%	14%	9%	11%	81.4	1739	15.8	-8.2	6.6	45%	17%	29%	.195	+1.0	60	70	45
Knuckle curve KC	292	**10%**	12%	7%	21%	8%	7%	5%	81.7	2664	-13.5	2.4	6.4	29%	17%	32%	.305	-0.6	40	50	40
Sinker SI	228	**8%**	5%	11%	8%	8%	8%	7%	95.8	2394	13.9	-11.2	6.4	12%	30%	25%	.326	+0.7	50	55	65
Sweeper ST	101	**3%**	1%	8%	6%	4%	2%	2%	83.4	2832	-8.9	11.7	6.3	23%	24%	33%	.237	-1.1	45	50	40

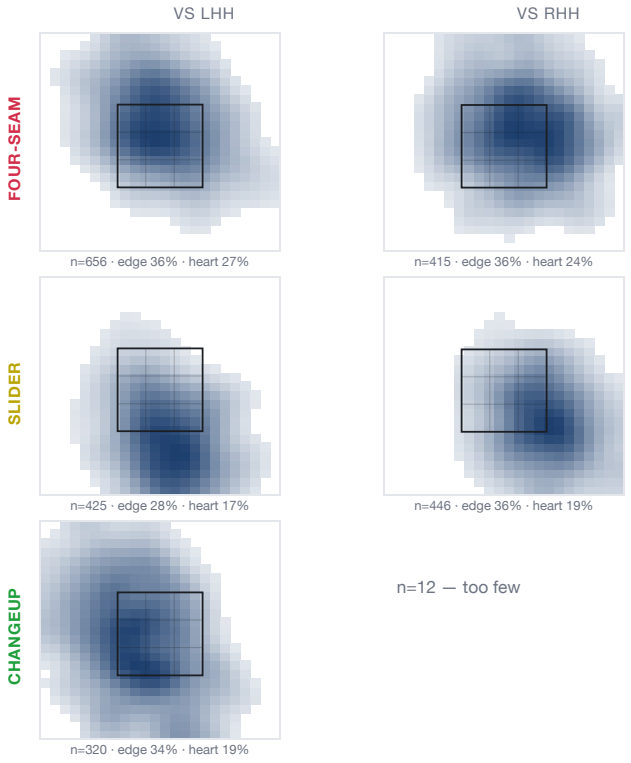
SHAPE Movement — four-seam carries 2.8 in more IVB than the average RHP four-seam

Dots = individual pitches (≤110 per type); large markers = his averages; dashed ellipses = league 1-SD shape for the same pitch type from RHPs. Inches, catcher view.



LOCATION Location — 56% of his four-seams finish in the upper third or above

Smoothed density of pitch locations (catcher view; box = average rule-book zone, thirds marked). Darker = more frequent (frequency, not quality) · edge = within ±3 in of the zone border.



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COUNTS Count strategy — most predictable in 2-0 vs RHH (56% four-seam)

Throws most = his most-used pitch in each count (tint: red = mixed, blue = ≥70% one pitch, i.e. predictable). Model pick = lowest expected xwOBA from the situational model vs a league-average hitter (◆ = differs). Mix gap = his actual mix's model xwOBA minus the model pick's, in points (.001); blue = larger opportunity.

VS LHH	0-0	1-0	2-0	3-0	0-1	1-1	2-1	3-1	0-2	1-2	2-2	3-2
Throws most	FF 43% n=402	FF 34% n=157	SL 42% n=57	FF 86% n=21	FF 38% n=209	FF 34% n=173	SL 40% n=93	FF 48% n=31	FF 38% n=117	SL 30% n=175	SL 31% n=161	FF 44% n=126
Model pick	FF	FF	FF ◆	SL ◆	FF	FF	FF ◆	SL ◆	FF	FF ◆	FF ◆	SL ◆
Mix gap (pts)	7	9	3	22	19	17	13	22	19	21	15	11

VS RHH	0-0	1-0	2-0	3-0	0-1	1-1	2-1	3-1	0-2	1-2	2-2	3-2
Throws most	SL 32% n=288	SL 44% n=107	FF 56% n=36	FF 93% n=15	SL 41% n=145	FF 35% n=111	SL 48% n=65	FF 45% n=29	SL 49% n=79	SL 42% n=125	FF 45% n=96	FF 55% n=77
Model pick	FF ◆	FF ◆	SL ◆	SL ◆	FF ◆	FF	FF ◆	SL ◆	FF ◆	FF ◆	FF	SL ◆
Mix gap (pts)	5	5	3	26	22	15	11	23	17	17	10	7

MOST PREDICTABLE

2-0 vs RHH · **56% FF** n=36
3-2 vs RHH · **55% FF** n=77
0-2 vs RHH · **49% SL** n=79

LARGEST MODEL GAPS

1-2 vs LHH · SL 30% → **FF** .279→.251
0-1 vs RHH · SL 41% → **FF** .287→.259
1-2 vs RHH · SL 42% → **FF** .277→.252

SEQUENCE Sequencing — FF/CH is the best tunnel pair (6.3× separation after the decision point)

Share (%) of next pitch within the same PA, by previous pitch. Tunnel = mean trajectories 23.8 ft from the plate vs at the plate.

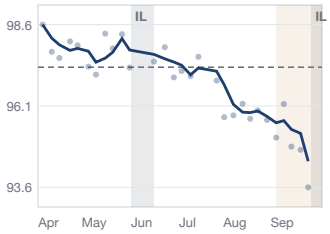
AFTER ↓ / NEXT →	FF	SL	CH	KC	SI	ST
FF n=802	43	29	11	9	5	2
SL n=633	33	42	10	3	9	3
CH n=264	33	33	16	8	8	2
KC n=259	33	25	22	8	9	3
SI n=162	44	33	4	6	7	6
ST n=84	31	36	10	2	17	5

Best tunnel: **FF/CH** — 1.4 in apart at the decision point, 8.8 in apart at the plate (6.3× late separation; release 1.2 in apart)
Slider after CH: **59% whiff** vs 42% overall (46 swings)
Four-seam after SL: **26% whiff** vs 21% overall (115 swings)

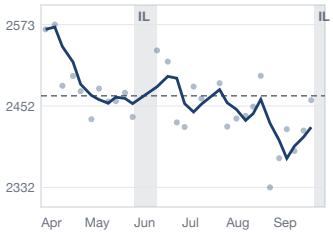
TRENDS Trends — primary FB velo down 2.4 mph over his last 5 games

Per game (dots), 3-game rolling mean (line), dashed = baseline before last 5 games; ⚑ shaded = flagged window (≥1 mph, 75 rpm or 0.2 ft). Grey = IL: May 25–Jun 9 (Left hamstring strain); Sep 20–Sep 28 (Right shoulder inflammation).

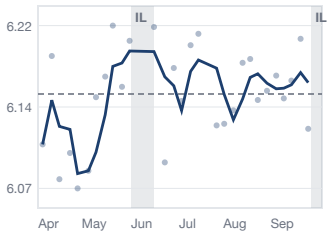
Primary FB velo (mph) ⚑ -2.4 last 5



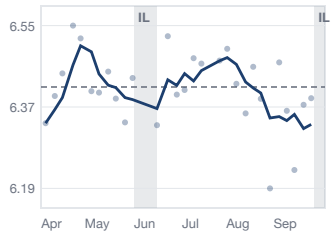
Primary FB spin (rpm)



Release height (ft)



Extension (ft)



SPLITS Splits — even platoon profile (0-pt xwOBA gap)

Statcast PAs, regular season. xwOBA tint vs league .315 (red = better for him). Times through order use the batter's PA count vs this pitcher in the game. Velo hold: primary FB +1.2 mph on pitches 76+ vs 1–25. Grey rows: < 60 PA.

SPLIT	PA	WOBA	XWOBA	K%	BB%	HR	WHIFF	CHASE
vs LHH	396	.252	.265	36.4%	11.6%	8	30%	31%
vs RHH	286	.270	.265	33.2%	11.2%	3	30%	33%
1st time	261	.249	.272	37.2%	11.5%	5	33%	32%
2nd time	258	.225	.230	36.8%	9.3%	2	30%	32%
3rd+ time	163	.330	.312	28.8%	14.7%	4	26%	31%

COMPS Comps — closest arsenal profile: Chase Burns

Nearest neighbors among qualified pitchers on pitch mix, primary-FB velo/IVB/HB, arm angle, breaking-ball shape and separation, whiff% and zone% (standardized, weighted). Chip = comp's Stuff grade.

Chase Burns CIN 75 — 69% similar
RHP SP · FB 97.6 mph, 19" IVB · FF 55% / SL 39%

Tarik Skubal LAD 60 — 56% similar
LHP SP · FB 96.8 mph, 17" IVB · FF 38% / CH 26% / SI 17% / SL 14%

Mason Montgomery PIT 70 — 56% similar
LHP RP · FB 98.5 mph, 18" IVB · FF 46% / SI 24% / SL 14% / CU 13%

DEVELOP Development notes — usage direction from the arsenal optimizer

Constrained optimizer on the outcome model (each pitch ±15 pts, 3–55% bounds). Expected gains are small and model-dependent: hypotheses for the pitching staff, not prescriptions.

vs LHH: FF 38→23%, SL 25→40%, CH 19→30% (model xwOBA -3 pts, n=1722)
vs RHH: SL 38→53%, FF 35→20%, ST 8→20% (model xwOBA -6 pts, n=1173)
Shape: his knuckle curve grades 40 Stuff. Top-quartile RHP curveballs average 19.9 in of horizontal separation from the fastball vs his 5.5 — the largest gap; worth a look in pitch design, not a prescription.

Grades. each scale is a z-score composite converted to a percentile within the qualified pool, then 50 + 10·Φ⁻¹(p), clipped 20–80 and shown to the nearest 5. Pitch grades are within the same pitch type and throwing hand (≥100 pitches). Stuff = a gradient-boosted model of expected, count-neutral run value from velo, movement, spin, extension, release, arm angle and separation from the primary fastball (no location or results; held-out pitch-type correlation r=0.37). Results = whiff%, CSW%, xwOBA. Command = edge%, waste%, heart% (pitch) and BB%, edge, zone, first-strike (overall). Durability = IP/start, pitches/game, late-game velo hold (relievers: G, IP). **Models.** count plan = situational pitch-type model (2026, generic league-average hitter, medium leverage, 2nd time through); location/tunneling from Statcast trajectory fits at a 23.8 ft decision point; usage suggestion = constrained arsenal optimizer (±15 pts/pitch). Model gaps are small effects — treat as direction. **Caveats.** single season, regular season only; small-sample cells greyed; xwOBA ignores park and defense; IL dates from MLB transactions (retroactive dates honored).